Matt & Hannah — Bar Scene

-- The bar is packed. Not a table free, so Matt and Han have claimed two stools at the counter. People crowd in around them. The woman behind Han is almost pressed against her back. Han shifts closer to Matt. --

-- Han casually snacks on complimentary pistachios. --

Han: Why are you so obsessed with this case? You've never given a damn about your job before.

Matt: Not true. I care about my cases… most of them. I'm just good at keeping work and personal life separate.

Han: Bullshit.

Matt: *(annoyed)* Oh, cut it, Han. It's been a long time since… you know. I'm a new person now! Better.

Han: I never thought you were a bad person. I've genuinely admired how indifferent you were to your workplace. I could never pull that off.

Matt *(serious)*: Why do you care that I care?

Han *(looking away)*: Just… worried about you. Seems like a tough case to crack.

-- A pause. Han cracks a pistachio between her teeth. --

Matt: I'm getting a dog.

Han *(blinking)*: What?

Matt: A dog. From the shelter. *(smiling)* His name's Bug.

-- The barman glances at them, visibly engaged. --

Han: …Why?

Matt: I live alone, don't move enough — you know what happens to men who sit around all day? He'll walk me, I'll walk him, you know.

Han: Are you seriously adopting a dog to avoid hemorrhoids?

Matt: Among other things, yes.

Han: *(sarcastic)* So *now* you care about your health.

Matt: I’m trying to.

Han: When was the last time you were home?

Matt: …

Han *(firm)*: When?

Matt: *(hesitant)* Day before yesterday.

Han: Firstly — ew.

Matt: *(annoyed)* We *do* have showers at work. Don’t be dramatic.

Han: You sure you can take care of it?

Matt: I just… I need to do this.

-- He pauses, searching for the right words. Han casually cracks another pistachio, waiting for his answer. --

Matt: I think it might help.

Han: Help with what?

Matt: Understanding her. Understanding what happened to her.

Han *(rubbing her forehead)*: Oh my god! You *are* crazy.

Matt: You don’t understand.

Han: *(annoyed)* You’re right. I don’t.

-- Matt avoids her gaze, studying the colorful bottles lining the backlit shelves behind the bar. --

Matt: I know what I’m doing. Trust me.

-- Han studies him, her eyes narrowing. --

Han: What’s she like?

Matt: *(taken aback)* What do you mean?

Han: The girl. Sel. What was she like?